

ENTREPRENEURSHIP FOR KIDS · AGES 8–12 · A CLASSROOM OR CO-OP, RUN BY A GROWN-UP

Start a Business Unit

A short, adult-led mini-unit that takes a whole **group** of kids from first idea to market day — five days, five simple deliverables, and one grown-up running the AI prompts that draft the printable materials for each step. Built for a classroom or homeschool co-op running a market day or pitch event, not a solo workbook — pair it with our single-kid *My First Business* and *Launch It* workbooks for kids who want to keep going after the unit ends.

BEFORE DAY ONE, THE RULE
You run every AI prompt in this unit.
Kids do the thinking; you do the typing.

The safety frame for this whole unit

- **Chatbots are for 13 and up.** Every prompt in this pack is written for the grown-up running the unit — never handed to a student to type themselves.
- **No child's name, photo, school, or street ever goes into a prompt.** Describe the group generically — "a class of 9-year-olds" — never who.
- **If market day goes online at all** (a class page, a sign-up sheet, photos shared with families), the grown-up runs that step start to finish.

What's in this pack

- **Day 1 — Idea Brainstorm & Problem-Spotting** — kids notice real problems and pitch first ideas.
- **Day 2 — Pricing with the Rule of Three** — simple math that turns cost into a fair price.
- **Day 3 — Making a Sign & the Pitch** — a sign kids design, and thirty seconds to sell it.
- **My Role & My Price** — a one-page write-in worksheet every kid fills out before market day.
- **Day 4 — Market Day Logistics** — the adult-run event-planning checklist: roles, tables, float, cleanup.
- **Day 5 — Debrief & Profit Math** — a simple ledger and reflection page after the sale.

DAY 1

Idea Brainstorm & Problem-Spotting

Kids work in pairs or small groups, spotting real problems and wants around them — at home, at school, in the neighborhood — and turning each one into a possible business idea. Post the themed prompt sheet where every group can see it; give each group five minutes per theme, then a quick share-out of their favorite idea.

AI Helper Prompt · draft the brainstorm-prompt sheet

"I'm running a business-idea brainstorm for a class of 8- to 12-year-olds in a market-day unit. Write six brainstorm prompts grouped by theme (helping neighbors, crafts and made items, games and fun, food with adult help) — each prompt should point kids toward noticing a real problem or want and turning it into an idea. Keep the language simple enough for an 8-year-old to read alone. Format it as a printable one-page handout with a blank line under each prompt for their idea."

Example ideas by theme

A quick preview of the kind of idea each theme can spark — share one or two out loud before groups start.

Theme	Example idea
Helping neighbors	Weeding, pet-sitting while an owner travels, carrying in groceries
Crafts & made items	Friendship bracelets, painted rocks, bookmarks
Games & fun	Face-painting table, a mini ring-toss booth, homemade puzzles
Food (with adult help)	Lemonade, no-bake cookie bags, popcorn

DAY 2

Pricing with the Rule of Three

Teach the Rule of Three: a fair starting price is roughly **materials cost $\times$ 3** — it covers what you spent, a little for your time, and a little profit to grow the business. Walk through one example together, then let groups work through practice scenarios in pairs before they price their own idea from Day 1.

AI Helper Prompt · generate pricing practice scenarios

"Generate eight simple pricing-practice scenarios for a class of 9- to 11-year-olds learning the 'Rule of Three' (price is about 3 times the materials cost). For each scenario, give the item and a materials cost, and leave space for kids to calculate a price. Keep the numbers easy — multiples of 25 cents or whole dollars — and don't include an answer key, since we'll work them out together."

Try it together first

Item	Materials cost	$\times 3$	Fair price
Friendship bracelet	\$0.75	$\times 3$	$\approx$ \$2.00
Cup of lemonade	\$0.30	$\times 3$	$\approx$ \$1.00
Bag of 3 cookies	\$0.60	$\times 3$	$\approx$ \$2.00

Round to a friendly number — customers pay in whole dollars and quarters faster than they pay in pennies.

KID WORKSHEET · FILL THIS OUT BY HAND, IN PEN OR PENCIL

My Role & My Price

1 · My business or team name

2 · My job on market day (circle one)

☐ **Cashier & Money Counter**

Takes payment, gives change

☐ **Greeter & Helper**

Welcomes shoppers, answers questions

☐ **Maker & Restocker**

Refills the table, fixes displays

☐ **Sign Artist & Announcer**

Makes signs, calls out to shoppers

3 · What our team is selling or making

4 · My price, using the Rule of Three

Materials cost $\times 3$ = my price

 $\times 3 =$

5 · One sentence I'll say to a customer

Practice it out loud before market day.

6 · Before market day

- ☐ I practiced my pitch out loud with a partner.
- ☐ My sign is finished and easy to read.
- ☐ I know my price and can explain it with the Rule of Three.

DAY 3

Making a Sign & the Pitch

Each kid or team designs a simple sign for their table — name, what they're selling, the price. Then partner up for pitch practice: thirty seconds to sell your idea to a partner, thirty seconds of kind, specific feedback in return. Rotate partners twice so everyone hears more than one voice.

AI Helper Prompt · draft pitch starters and feedback stems

"Write ten kid-friendly pitch-sentence starters (for example, 'The best part about my ____ is...') and eight peer-feedback sentence stems that a group of 8- to 12-year-olds can use to give each other kind, specific feedback on a 30-second sales pitch. Keep the tone simple and encouraging, and format both lists for a printable handout."

What every good sign needs

- ☐ **The business name** — big enough to read from across the room.
- ☐ **What's for sale** — one clear line, no fine print.
- ☐ **The price** — large, and the same price they'll say out loud.
- ☐ **One line that makes it exciting** — a color, a smell, a promise ("still warm!").

DAY 4

Market Day Logistics

No AI needed today — just a straightforward checklist the grown-up runs.

Role	What they do	Who's covering it
Cashier & Money Counter	Collects payment, gives change	
Greeter & Helper	Welcomes shoppers, answers questions	
Maker & Restocker	Refills tables, fixes displays	
Sign Artist & Announcer	Signage, calls out to shoppers	

Before, during, after

- ☐ **Tables & set-up** — one table per team, a cloth or paper covering, price signs taped down.
- ☐ **The float** — \$5–10 in small bills and coins per table, so kids can make change from the first sale.
- ☐ **A cash box or envelope** per team, plus a simple tally sheet for the Day 5 debrief.
- ☐ **Cleanup crew** — assign who folds tables, who collects trash, who returns supplies.
- ☐ **A grown-up circulating** to help with tricky change, shy sellers, or a line that's too long.

Sample day-of timeline

Time	What's happening
15 min before	Tables up, floats counted with a grown-up, signs taped down
Doors open	Greeters welcome the first shoppers
Mid-event	Maker & Restocker refills; grown-up circulates for change help
Last 10 min	Final sales, last call from the Sign Artist & Announcer
After	Cleanup crew folds tables; cash boxes go straight to the Day 5 ledger

DAY 5

Debrief & Profit Math

After market day, kids fill in what they actually sold, then work out their profit — the last and best math lesson of the unit.

Item sold	Price	How many sold	Total

Profit math

Total sales _____ – materials cost _____ = profit _____

Reflection

What worked well?

What would I change next time?

What was the hardest part of the whole unit?

Wrap up as a group: read a few reflections out loud, then post the class's total sales and total profit somewhere everyone can see it — a satisfying last number for a unit that started with a blank sheet of paper.

Two more stops on this path: My First Business (ages 6–10) walks one kid through their very first idea, solo — and Launch It (ages 9–12) takes a solo entrepreneur all the way to a written business plan and pitch practice. Both in our TpT store.